# Md Farhan Ishmam

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## Current Research Interests

Web and computer-use agents (evaluation, harnesses, post-training), multi-agent systems, knowledge acquisition, vision-language (robustness, adapters, modality alignment), multimodal systems under distribution shift.

## Education

- **University of Utah** — Salt Lake City, UT, USA
  *PhD in Computing (AI Track)* — *Aug 2025 - Present*
  *MS in Computing (AI Track)* — *Aug 2025 - May 2027 (expected)*
  - **Research:** Evaluation, Harnesses, and Post-Training for Web and Computer-Use Agents
  - **Advisor:** Prof. Kenneth Marino
- **Islamic University of Technology (IUT)** — Dhaka, Bangladesh
  *BS, **Major**: Computer Science, **Minor**: Computer Engineering, GPA: 3.96/4.00* — *Jan 2019 - May 2023*
  - **Thesis:** Visual Robustness Analysis of VQA and Caption Ranking in Zero-Shot VQA

## Open-Source Contributions

- **BrowserGym** (Maintainer) — browser-agent environment & benchmarks, *ServiceNow* [PR#385] [PR#397]
- **AgentLab** (Maintainer) — browser agent harness, *ServiceNow* [PR#330] [PR#336]
- **Cube Harness** (Maintainer) — general agent harness, *The AI Alliance* [PR#512] [PR#525]

## Research

A: Agents, V: Vision-Language, M: Multilingual, L: Language Gen

**Agents, Computer Use, and Evaluation**

A9 Don't Retrain, Remix: Adaptation of Web Agents using Mixture Hypernetworks
**MF Ishmam**, MP Dinh, K Marino
*arXiv 2026* [Project Page] [Paper] [Code]

A8 Teaching Agents in their Own Style: Blackbox Teacher Distillation for Web Agents
**MF Ishmam**, K Marino
*arXiv 2026* [Project Page] [Paper] [Code]

A7 Back to Basics: Drills Before Games for Web Agents
MP Dinh, **MF Ishmam**, HY Prieto, RH Joarder, K Marino
*In-Review 2026* [Project Page] [Dataset]

A6 SLMs are Almost Zero-shot Agents
RH Joarder, **MF Ishmam**, FH Chaleshtori, K Marino
*In-Review 2026*

A5 TimeWarp: Evaluating Web Agents by Revising the Past
**MF Ishmam**, K Marino
*NeurIPS Evaluations and Datasets Track 2026* [Project Page] [Paper] [Code] [Dataset]

A4 DORA Explorer: Improving the Exploration Ability of LLMs Without Training
P Gurjar, **MF Ishmam**, K Marino
*arXiv 2026* [Project Page] [Paper] [Code]

A3 The Hard Part Comes After Search: Benchmarking Web Agents on Synthesizing, Organizing, ... Knowledge
A Gill, **MF Ishmam**, X Nguyen, N Bhat, P DeYoung, F Chaleshtori, N Stringham, K Marino, A Marasovic
*Findings of EMNLP 2026* [Project Page] [Paper] [Code] [Dataset]

A2 QualCoder: A Quality-Driven Multi-Agent Framework for Automated Code Generation
SS Apurbo, ZZ Arpa, NKK Oishee, **MF Ishmam**, ARM Kamal, MA Hossain
*In-Review 2026* [Paper]

A1 Computer Use Survey - A Visual Survey of Computer Use Agents
K Marino, **MF Ishmam**, A Marasovic
*ICLR Blogpost Track 2026* [Blog]

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**Vision-Language & Robustness**

V6 M-WSPO: Weak-to-Strong Preference Optimization for Visually Grounded Multimodal Alignment
MZ Hossain*, **MF Ishmam***, Md Fahim, K Marino, A Imteaj
*In-Review 2026*

V5 R-MMA: Vision-Language Models with Recurrent Adapters for Few-Shot and Cross-Domain Generalization
M Fahim*, **MF Ishmam***, MS Hossain, MA Amin, AA Ali, AKMM Rahman
*WACV 2026* [Paper] [Suppl. Material]

V4 Enhancing Vision Language Corruption Robustness using Cross Distribution & Prompted Denoisers
SS Latif*, S Shiper*, KMR Kiran*, **MF Ishmam***, MA Hossain, ARM Kamal, MH Ashmafee
*WACV 2026* [Paper] [Suppl. Material] [Code]

V3 BanglaProtha: Evaluating Vision Language Models in Underrepresented Long-tail Cultural Contexts
M Fahim*, M Sourove*, AM Mazumder*, **MF Ishmam***, MTR Adib, FT Shifat, F Haider, M Bhuiyan
*WACV 2026* [Paper] [Suppl. Material] [Code] [Dataset]

V2 Visual Robustness Benchmark for Visual Question Answering (VQA)
**MF Ishmam***, I Tashdeed*, TA Saadat*, MH Ashmafee, ARM Kamal, MA Hossain
*WACV 2025* [Paper] [Suppl. Material] [Code]

V1 From Image to Language: A Critical Analysis of Visual Question Answering (VQA) Approaches, Challenges, and Opportunities
**MF Ishmam**, MS Shovon, MF Mridha, N Dey
*Information Fusion 2024* [Paper] [Preprint]

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**Multilingual & Low-Resource NLP**

M5 BanHADEX: Towards Explainable HAte Speech Detection in Bangla Using Human Annotated EXplanation
FH Raquib, AM Mazumder, M Fahim, TH Fuad, **MF Ishmam**, F Sultana, MA Amin, AA Ali, AM Rahman
*ACL 2026* [Paper] [Code] [Dataset]

M4 Robustness of LLMs to Transliteration Perturbations in Bangla
F Haider*, **MF Ishmam***, FT Shifat, MTR Adib, M Fahim, M Bhuiyan
*Best Paper* at *Bangla Language Processing (BLP) Workshop, IJCNLP-AACL 2025* [Paper] [Code]

M3 ChitroJera: A Regionally Relevant Visual Question Answering Dataset for Bangla
DD Barua*, M Sourove*, M Fahim*, F Haider, FT Shifat, M Adib, AB Uddin, **MF Ishmam**, M Bhuiyan
*ECML PKDD 2025* [Paper] [Code] [Dataset]

M2 BanTH: A Multi-label Hate Speech Detection Dataset for Transliterated Bangla
F Haider*, FT Shifat*, **MF Ishmam***, DD Barua, M Sourove, M Fahim, M Bhuiyan
*Findings of NAACL 2025* [Paper] [Code] [Dataset]

M1 BanglaTLit: A Benchmark Dataset for Back-Transliteration of Romanized Bangla
M Fahim*, FT Shifat*, F Haider*, DD Barua, M Sourove, **MF Ishmam**, M Bhuiyan
*Findings of EMNLP 2024* [Paper] [Code] [Dataset]

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**Language Generation**

L2 Can LLMs Tell Stories Out of Order? A Corpus and Benchmark for Nonlinear Narrative Generation
SR Raiyan*, Md Tariquzzaman*, **MF Ishmam**, T Huang
*ArXiv 2026* [Project Page] [Paper] [Code]

L1 FrugalPrompt: Minimizing Contextual Overhead of LLMs
SR Raiyan*, **MF Ishmam***, AA Imran, MA Moni
*Language Understanding in the Human-Machine Era (LUHME), EMNLP 2026* [Project Page] [Paper] [Code]

* denotes equal contribution

## Industry & Research Experience

- **Yaana Technologies, AI Lab** — Milpitas, CA, USA (Remote)
  *AI Research Intern — LLM-based Multi-Agent Systems* — *May 2026 - Aug 2026*
- **University of Utah, SPARK Lab** — Salt Lake City, UT, USA
  *Graduate Research Assistant — Web & Computer-Use Agents* — *Aug 2025 - Present*
- **Yaana Technologies, AI Lab** — Milpitas, CA, USA (Remote)
  *AI Researcher — Multi-Agent LLM Systems* — *Sep 2023 - Aug 2025*
- **Penta Global Limited, AI Research** — Dhaka, Bangladesh
  *AI Researcher — Bengali Vision-Language & Transliteration Systems* — *May 2023 and Aug 2023*
- **HawarIT Limited, R&D** — Dhaka, Bangladesh (Hybrid)
  *Research Intern — Depth Estimation using Stereo Vision* — *Oct 2021 and Dec 2021*

## Teaching Experience

- **Islamic University of Technology** — Dhaka, Bangladesh
  *Lecturer, Department of Computer Science and Engineering* — *Aug 2023 - July 2025*

## Awards & Achievements

- PhD Fellowship at Kahlert School of Computing, University of Utah.
- Best Paper, Bangla Language Processing (BLP) Workshop at IJCNLP-AACL 2025.
- Finalist (Top-7) at Robi Datathon 3.0, Bangladesh's largest data science event with 3,500+ participants.
- IUT Research Seed Grant (IUT RSG) (Ref: REASP/IUT-RSG/2022/OL/07/012) — $5,000 grant covering research resources, conference registration, and travel.